



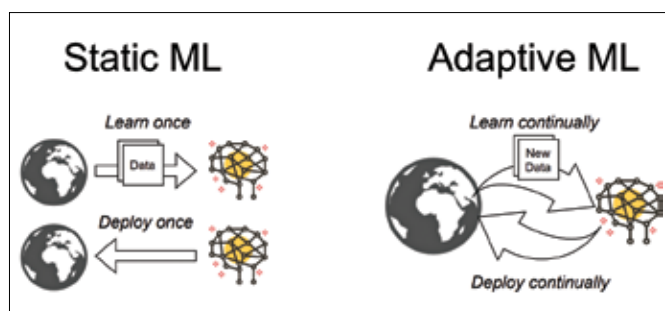
Apple in India

Apple accelerates plans to manufacture in India, thanks to Covid-19 policies in China. <https://digit.in/dec22-19>



iPhone 15 Ultra?

The iPhone 15 Ultra could come with a new design by "curving the bottom edge." <https://digit.in/dec22-20>



RENEWABLE RESOURCES

To conserve exhaustible energy like fuel (recently, Asian countries like Sri Lanka and Bangladesh from the Subcontinent faced one of the worst fuel crises), can renewable resources or alternate sources of energy be exploited other than batteries for use in EVs?

"Even in energy-efficient technologies like hydrogen, unless you are in full control of the energy reaction, you need a medium to store the generated power. Therefore, battery power can never be ignored," warns Bohre in response to the above query. India is a densely-populated nation and considering the poor condition of its roads, can vehicles be remote-controlled here? "Currently, the answer is a strict no-no. However, with the advent of 5G networks and India's extensive Internet coverage, this is quite possible in the near future," assures Bohre.

ROLE OF TRAFFIC REGULATORS

How important will it be to stay connected to the traffic control department while running self-driving vehicles on roads? "It is highly crucial as the traffic department plays a significant role in effecting autonomous driving technology in the public sphere, which belongs to the jurisdiction of the traffic manning office. Another reason is that AI cannot work effectively without providing the processors with real-time analysis via CCTV cameras on the road and inside a vehicle as well," justifies Bohre.

As a town planner, Sen draws a different angle to the vital role that a major ministerial portfolio like traffic management ought to play in coordinating with the township authorities

Indian roads. Instead, the transport department should cooperate with the city administration to better the road-safety standards through AI-aided CCTVs, advance warnings and automatic imposition of fines for rule violations," he volunteers.

SMART COMMUNITIES

As urbanization with its truckloads of construction activity steadily sprawls to the outskirts, the growing concept of smart cities and townships with state-of-the-art amenities become unmistakably essential. This not only includes residential complexes and commercial establishments dotting the city's empty spaces but also the well-constructed roads and an efficient transport system to iron out communication creases.

Do you feel that to save fuel, curb pollution levels and address the climate change woes, more and more electric vehicles should be launched in smart towns? "Absolutely. I think all smart cities must prioritise EVs as part of their foremost agenda. Beyond the climate change point of view, purely from a humane perspective, such sustainable actions underline the promise of making all citizens breathe in clean air," concurs Sen.

GREEN ZONES

Should there be separate lanes for eco-friendly transport like cycles and EVs to facilitate their traffic management? "We already laid down 35 km long cycle tracks in New Town and plan to extend this to 50 km soon. We strongly believe that safety is supremely important to cyclists and the segregated green cycle tracks,

for surveillance of roads with the autonomous vehicles. "I am not quite comfortable with the idea of unpacking driverless sedans on

marked with flexible green plastic bollards and zebra crossings made cycles hugely popular," shares Sen. Battery-charged electric vehicles are the key to many solutions like addressing environmental pollution, say green activists in unison. In line with this objective, green mobility is the latest revolution to underscore. EVs are therefore an eco-friendly mode of transport to check the carbon footprint for a clean environment. Custodians of pollution control board underpin the need for emission-free conveyances to comply with the decarbonisation campaign.

"Green duty should top the list of every state's growth policies. I'm happy that my city had already phased out 15-year old buses, readily responding to the transport ministry's directive," ascertains environmentalist Rupam Kumar Dutta. "Launch of EVs for both personal and public travel is a positive step indeed," he appreciates. "See, when you are aboard a ship that is sailing in turbulent waters, you don't really wait for the storm to topple it and see things spiralling out of your hand until the vessel sinks, right? You act on it immediately. So, the ruling regime must overlook the exorbitant expenditure involved in taking such organic initiatives urgently for common good," reasons Dutta, also an assistant college lecturer and doubling up as the treasurer of the Institute of Landscape, Ecology and Ekistics (ILEE).

Resting all speculations, pollution consultant Goutam Sengupta said that "pollution is a localized problem and requires an area-specific solution. There is no universal message or a way out to stop this." "You see, planting saplings along the busiest roads can hardly help trim the toxic emission to zero levels. Climate change is a global phenomenon to cope with. Harmful contaminants, urbanization with inadequate green cover, excessive construction activity, deforestation and industrialization are widely blamed for this disaster," perceives Sengupta. 